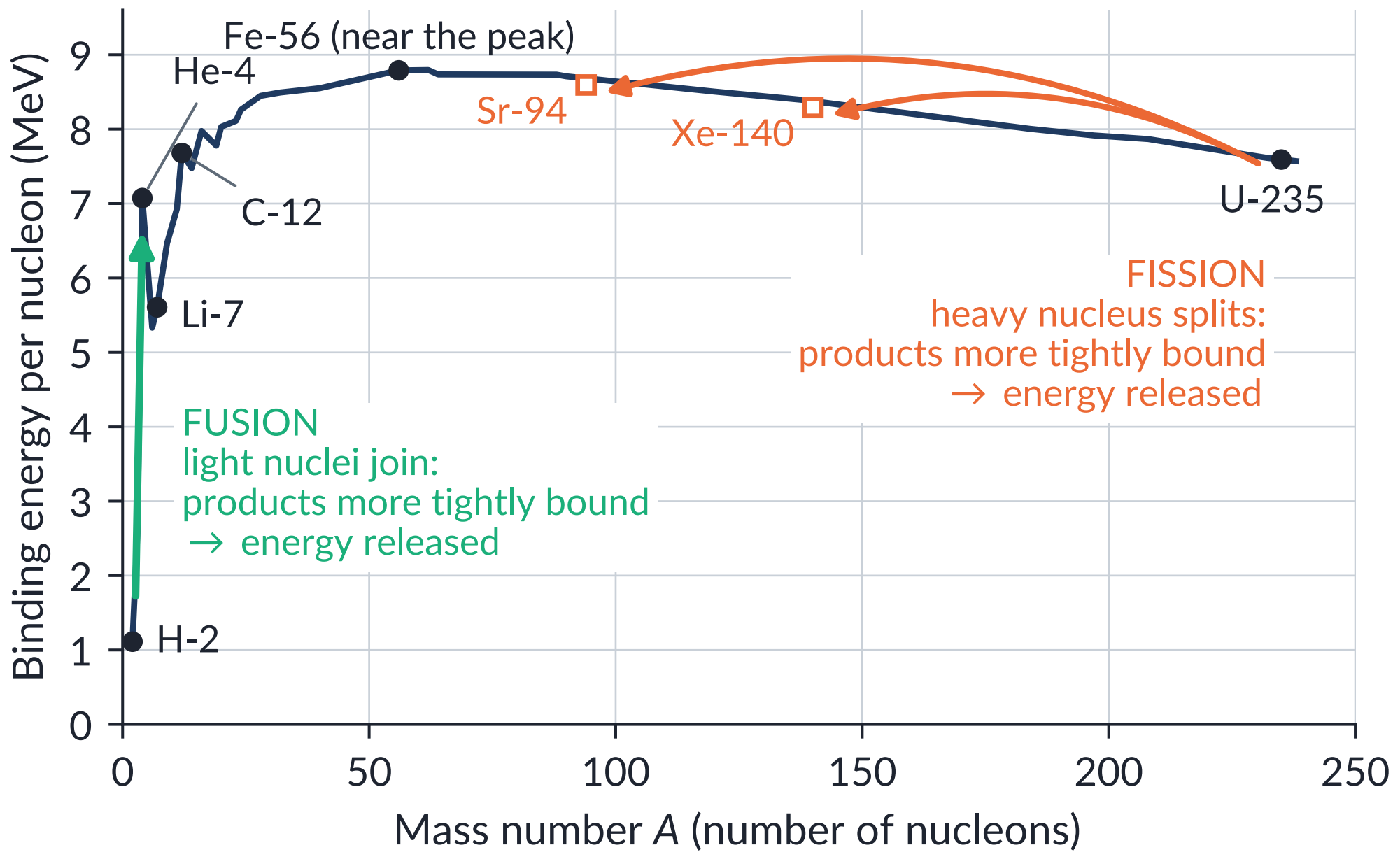
Fe-56 (near the peak)
He-4
Sr-94
Xe-140
C-12
U-235
Li-7
FISSION
heavy nucleus splits:
products more tightly bound
→ energy released
FUSION
light nuclei join:
products more tightly bound
→ energy released
H-2
Binding energy per nucleon (MeV)
0
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
0
50
100
150
200
250
Mass number A (number of nucleons)